67. de Lacy Evans, On the Practicability of an Invasion of British India , front page. Emphasis in original. Peter the Great's project is explained further on.

68. Curzon, Russia in Central Asia in 1889 and the Anglo-Russian Question , pp. 320–321 (hereafter Russia).

69. Yapp, 'British Perceptions of the Russian Threat to India', Modern Asian Studies , Vol. 21, No. 4 (1987), pp. 647–65.

70. Prestona, 'Sir Charles MacGregor and the Defence of India, 1857–1887', The Historical Journal , Vol. 12, No. 1 (1969), pp. 58–77.

71. Williams, op. cit., pp. 360–363.

72. Hopkirk, Great Game , pp. 26–30.

73. A squadron of Orenburg Cossacks was dispatched in January 1801 but was recalled when Paul was deposed and killed in March: Yapp, op. cit., pp. 664–5.

74. That McNeill, an ardent Russophobe, was appointed minister to Tehran is indicative of the nature of Anglo-Russian relations at the time. Habberton, op. cit., p. 9.

75. Hopkirk, Great Game , pp. 163–4.

76. McLean, Buffer State , p. 14.

77. Hopkirk, Great Game , p. 20.

78. As quoted in Meyer and Brysac, op. cit., p. 121.

79. A term borrowed by Meyer and Brysac for their book on the subject: Meyer and Brysac, op. cit., p. xviii.

80. Beaverbrook, op. cit., p. 46.